

Mathematics for Information Technology

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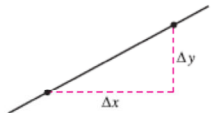
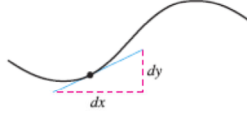
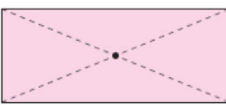
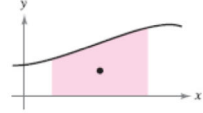
What is calculus?

- Calculus is the **mathematics of changes**.
 - Mathematics of velocity, accelerations, tangent lines, slopes, areas, volumes, arc lengths, centroids, curvatures, etc.
 - To model real-life situations.
- Precalculus** mathematics is more **static**, whereas **calculus** is more **dynamic**.

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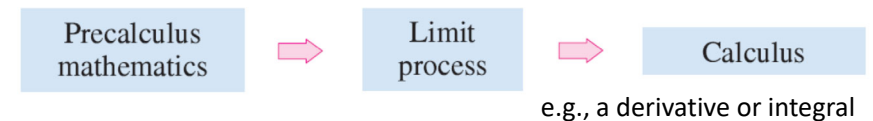
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What is calculus? Example

Without Calculus	With Differential Calculus
Slope of a line 	Slope of a curve 
Average rate of change between $t = a$ and $t = b$ 	Instantaneous rate of change at $t = c$ 
Curvature of a circle 	Curvature of a curve 
Without Calculus	With Integral Calculus
Center of a rectangle 	Centroid of a region 

What is calculus?

- The **reformulation** of **precalculus** mathematics through the use of a **limit process**.
- The calculus is a “**limit machine**” that involves three stages.



- DO NOT** learn calculus as if it were simply a collection of new formulas.
 - Miss a great deal of understanding.

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FUNCTION LIMIT AND CONTINUITY

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Function

• OBJECTIVES

Learn ...

- Function definition
- Function notation
- Domain and range of a function
- A function of x

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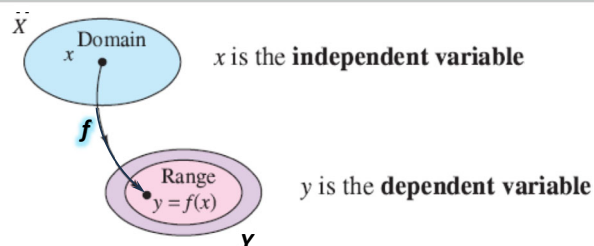
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Functions Definition

DEFINITION OF A REAL-VALUED FUNCTION OF A REAL VARIABLE

Let X and Y be sets of real numbers. A **real-valued function f of a real variable x** from X to Y is a correspondence that assigns to each number x in X exactly one number y in Y .

The **domain** of f is the set X . The number y is the **image** of x under f and is denoted by $f(x)$, which is called the **value of f at x** . The **range** of f is a subset of Y and consists of all images of numbers in X .



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Function Notation

$$x^2 + 2y = 1$$

Equation in **implicit form**

$$y = \frac{1}{2}(1 - x^2)$$

Equation in **explicit form**

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}(1 - x^2).$$

Function notation

The symbol $f(x)$ is read “ f of x .”

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Domain of a Function

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{x^2 - 4}, \quad 4 \leq x \leq 5$$

Explicitly

an explicitly defined domain given by $\{x: 4 \leq x \leq 5\}$

$$g(x) = \frac{1}{x^2 - 4}$$

Implicitly

an implied domain that is the set $\{x: x \neq \pm 2\}$

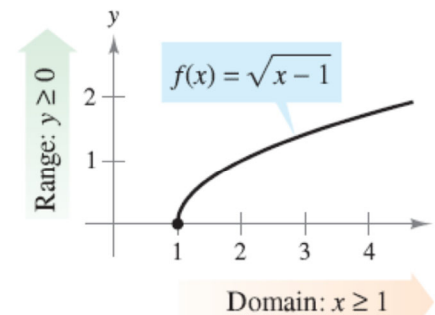
Finding the Domain and Range of a Function

The domain of the function

A real-valued function of a real variable

$$f(x) = \sqrt{x - 1}$$

is the set of all x -values for which $x - 1 \geq 0$, which is the interval $[1, \infty)$. To find the range, observe that $f(x) = \sqrt{x - 1}$ is never negative. So, the range is the interval $[0, \infty)$



A function from X to Y is **one-to-one** if to each y -value in the range there corresponds exactly one x -value in the domain

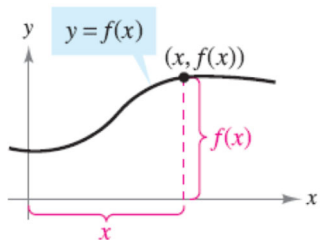
A function from X to Y is **onto** if its range consists of all Y .

Is this function one-to-one?

Is this function onto?



A Function of x



x = the directed distance from the y -axis
 $f(x)$ = the directed distance from the x -axis.

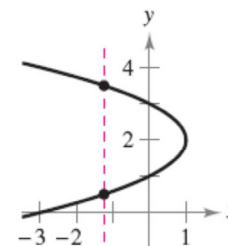
The graph of a function

A function of x

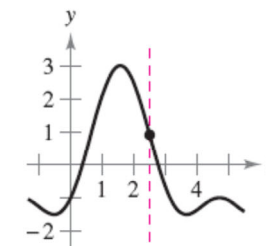
A vertical line can intersect the graph of a function of x at most *once*.



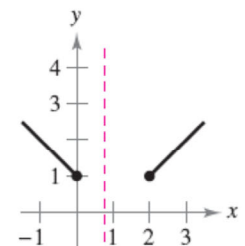
Vertical Line Test



(a) ?????????????



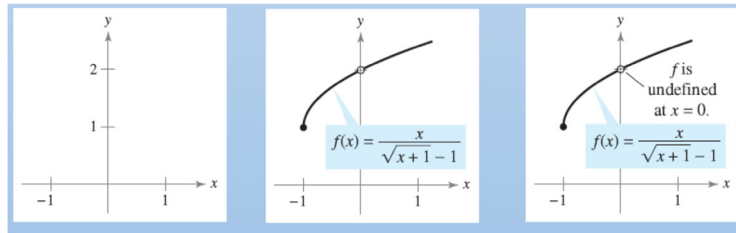
(b) ?????????????



(c) ?????????????

Limit and Their Properties

- The **limit** of a function is the primary concept that distinguishes **calculus** from **algebra** and **analytic geometry**.
- One technique of estimating a limit is to ...
 - Graph the function AND
 - Determine the behavior of the graph as the independent variable approaches a specific value.



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Limit and Their Properties



According to NASA, the coldest place in the known universe is the Boomerang nebula. The nebula is five thousand light years from Earth and has a temperature of -272°C . That is only 1° warmer than absolute zero, the coldest possible temperature.

How did scientists determine that absolute zero is the “lower limit” of the temperature of matter?

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Limit and Their Properties

OBJECTIVES

Learn how to ...

- Find **limits graphically** and **numerically**.
- Evaluate **limits analytically**.
- Determine **continuity** at a point and on an open interval.
- Determine **one-sided limits**.

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Finding Limits Graphically and Numerically

Objectives

- **Estimate a limit** using a numerical or graphical approaches.
- Learn different way that a **limit** can **fail to exist**.

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An Introduction to Limits

Numerical Approach

Suppose you are asked to sketch the graph

$$f(x) = \frac{x^3 - 1}{x - 1}, \quad x \neq 1.$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} f(x) = ?$$

x approaches 1 from the left.

x approaches 1 from the right.

x	0.75	0.9	0.99	0.999	1	1.001	1.01	1.1	1.25
$f(x)$	2.313	2.710	2.970	2.997	?	3.003	3.030	3.310	3.813

An Introduction to Limits

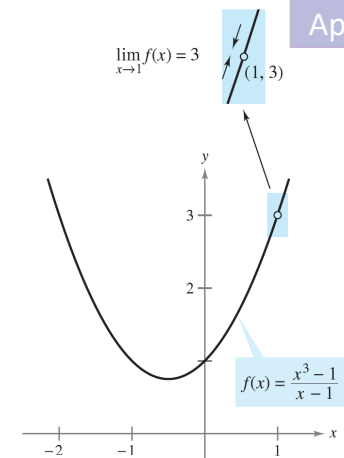
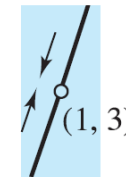
Graphical Approach

Suppose you are asked to sketch the graph

$$f(x) = \frac{x^3 - 1}{x - 1}, \quad x \neq 1.$$

This leads to a definition of limit.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} f(x) = 3$$



This is read as “the limit of $f(x)$ as x approaches 1 is 3.”

An Introduction to Limits

Numerical Approach

EXAMPLE 1 Estimating a Limit Numerically

Evaluate the function $f(x) = x/(\sqrt{x+1} - 1)$ at several points near $x = 0$ and use the results to estimate the limit

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{x}{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}$$

Why near $x = 0$?

Solution The table lists the values of $f(x)$ for several x -values near 0.

x approaches 0 from the left.

x approaches 0 from the right.

x	-0.01	-0.001	-0.0001	0	0.0001	0.001	0.01
$f(x)$	1.99499	1.99950	1.99995	?	2.00005	2.00050	2.00499

$f(x)$ approaches 2.

$f(x)$ approaches 2.

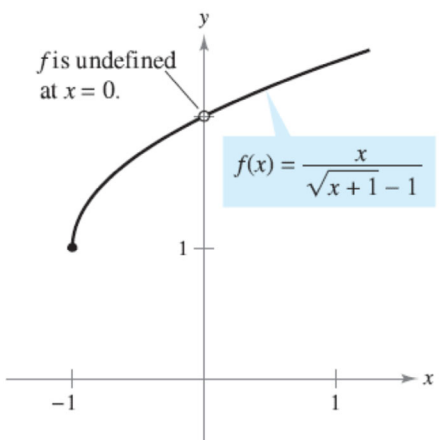
An Introduction to Limits

Graphical Approach

From the results shown in the table, you can estimate the limit to be 2. This limit is reinforced by the graph of f

- The function is undefined at $x = 0$.

The **existence or nonexistence** of $f(x)$ at $x = c$ has no bearing on the **existence of the limit of $f(x)$ as x approaches c .**



The limit of $f(x)$ as x approaches 0 is 2.

EXAMPLE 2 Finding a Limit

Find the limit of $f(x)$ as x approaches 2, where f is defined as

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 1, & x \neq 2 \\ 0, & x = 2 \end{cases}$$

An Introduction to Limits

นิยาม

1. $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = b$ หมายถึง ถ้า x เข้าใกล้ a แล้ว $f(x)$ จะเข้าใกล้ค่า b

2. $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x)$ จะหาค่าได้ ก็ต่อเมื่อ $\lim_{x \rightarrow a^-} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow a^+} f(x)$

$\lim_{x \rightarrow a^-} f(x)$ เรียกว่า Left hand Limit

$\lim_{x \rightarrow a^+} f(x)$ เรียกว่า Right hand Limit

Limits That Fail to Exist

EXAMPLE 3 Behavior That Differs from the Right and from the Left 1/3

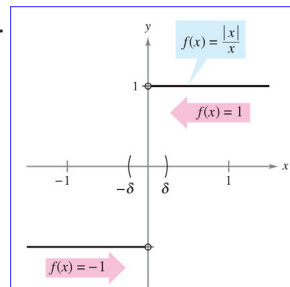
Show that the limit $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{|x|}{x}$ does not exist.

Solution Consider the graph of the function $f(x) = |x|/x$. definition of absolute value

$$|x| = \begin{cases} x, & \text{if } x \geq 0 \\ -x, & \text{if } x < 0 \end{cases} \quad \text{Definition of absolute value}$$

you can see that

$$\frac{|x|}{x} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } x > 0 \\ -1, & \text{if } x < 0 \end{cases}$$

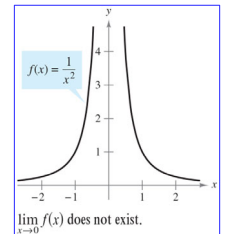


This means that no matter how close x gets to 0, there will be both positive and negative x -values that yield $f(x) = 1$ or $f(x) = -1$.

Limits That Fail to Exist

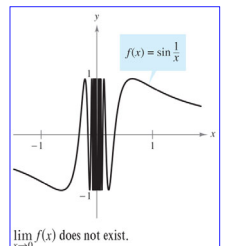
EXAMPLE 4 Unbounded Behavior 2/3

Discuss the existence of the limit $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{x^2}$.



EXAMPLE 5 Oscillating Behavior 3/3

Discuss the existence of the limit $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \sin \frac{1}{x}$.



Limits That Fail to Exist

COMMON TYPES OF BEHAVIOR ASSOCIATED WITH NONEXISTENCE OF A LIMIT

1. $f(x)$ approaches a different number from the right side of c than it approaches from the left side.
2. $f(x)$ increases or decreases without bound as x approaches c .
3. $f(x)$ oscillates between two fixed values as x approaches c .

Finding Limits

1. Numerical approach
2. Graphical approach
3. Analytic approach

Construct a table of values.

Draw a graph by hand or using technology.

Use algebra or calculus.

Later in this lecture ...

Evaluating Limits Analytically

Objectives

- Evaluate a limit using **properties of limits**.
- Develop and use a **strategy for finding limits**.
- Evaluate a limit using **dividing out and rationalizing techniques**.

Properties of Limits

- It may sometimes happen that the limit is precisely $f(c)$.
 - The limit is evaluated by **direct substitution**.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = f(c).$$

Substitute c for x .

Such *well-behaved* functions are **continuous at c** .

Properties of Limits

THEOREM 1.1 SOME BASIC LIMITS

Let b and c be real numbers and let n be a positive integer.

1. $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} b = b$
2. $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} x = c$
3. $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} x^n = c^n$

EXAMPLE 1 Evaluating Basic Limits

- a. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} 3 = ?$ b. $\lim_{x \rightarrow -4} x = ?$ c. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} x^2 = ?$

Properties of Limits

THEOREM 1.2 PROPERTIES OF LIMITS

Let b and c be real numbers, let n be a positive integer, and let f and g be functions with the following limits.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = L \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow c} g(x) = K$$

1. Scalar multiple: $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} [b f(x)] = bL$
2. Sum or difference: $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} [f(x) \pm g(x)] = L \pm K$
3. Product: $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} [f(x)g(x)] = LK$
4. Quotient: $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} = \frac{L}{K}$, provided $K \neq 0$
5. Power: $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} [f(x)]^n = L^n$

EXAMPLE 2 The Limit of a Polynomial

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} (4x^2 + 3) &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} 4x^2 + \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} 3 && \text{Property 2} \\ &= 4 \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} x^2 \right) + \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} 3 && \text{Property 1} \\ &= 4(2^2) + 3 && \text{Example 1} \\ &= 19 && \text{Simplify.} \end{aligned}$$

simply the value of p at $x = 2$.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} p(x) = p(2) = 4(2^2) + 3 = 19$$

This *direct substitution* property is valid for all polynomial and rational functions with nonzero denominators.

THEOREM 1.3 LIMITS OF POLYNOMIAL AND RATIONAL FUNCTIONS

If p is a polynomial function and c is a real number, then

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} p(x) = p(c).$$

If r is a rational function given by $r(x) = p(x)/q(x)$ and c is a real number such that $q(c) \neq 0$, then

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} r(x) = r(c) = \frac{p(c)}{q(c)}.$$

EXAMPLE 3 The Limit of a Rational Function

Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^2 + x + 2}{x + 1}$.

Solution Because the denominator is not 0 when $x = 1$, you can apply Theorem 1.3 to obtain

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^2 + x + 2}{x + 1} = \frac{1^2 + 1 + 2}{1 + 1} = \frac{4}{2} = 2.$$

BREAK

THEOREM 1.4 THE LIMIT OF A FUNCTION INVOLVING A RADICAL

Let n be a positive integer. The following limit is valid for all c if n is odd, and is valid for $c > 0$ if n is even.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} \sqrt[n]{x} = \sqrt[n]{c}$$

THEOREM 1.5 THE LIMIT OF A COMPOSITE FUNCTION

If f and g are functions such that $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} g(x) = L$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow L} f(x) = f(L)$, then

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(g(x)) = f\left(\lim_{x \rightarrow c} g(x)\right) = f(L).$$

EXAMPLE 4 The Limit of a Composite Function

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \sqrt{x^2 + 4}$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} (x^2 + 4) = 0^2 + 4 = 4$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 4} \sqrt{x} = \sqrt{4} = 2$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \sqrt{x^2 + 4} = \sqrt{4} = 2.$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \sqrt[3]{2x^2 - 10}$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 3} (2x^2 - 10) = 2(3^2) - 10 = 8$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 8} \sqrt[3]{x} = \sqrt[3]{8} = 2$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \sqrt[3]{2x^2 - 10} = \sqrt[3]{8} = 2.$$

THEOREM 1.6 LIMITS OF TRIGONOMETRIC FUNCTIONS

Let c be a real number in the domain of the given trigonometric function.

$$1. \lim_{x \rightarrow c} \sin x = \sin c$$

$$2. \lim_{x \rightarrow c} \cos x = \cos c$$

$$3. \lim_{x \rightarrow c} \tan x = \tan c$$

$$4. \lim_{x \rightarrow c} \cot x = \cot c$$

$$5. \lim_{x \rightarrow c} \sec x = \sec c$$

$$6. \lim_{x \rightarrow c} \csc x = \csc c$$

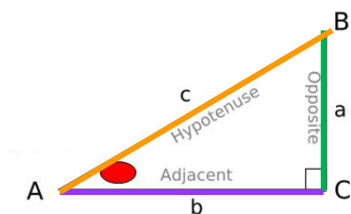
EXAMPLE 5 Limits of Trigonometric Functions

$$a. \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \tan x = ?$$

$$b. \lim_{x \rightarrow \pi} (x \cos x) = ?$$

$$c. \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \sin^2 x = ?$$

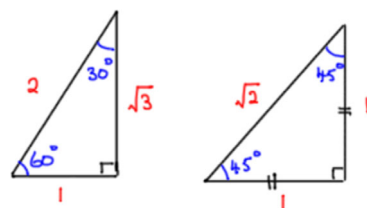
Note!! Trigonometry



$$\sin A = a/c \quad \operatorname{cosec} A = c/a$$

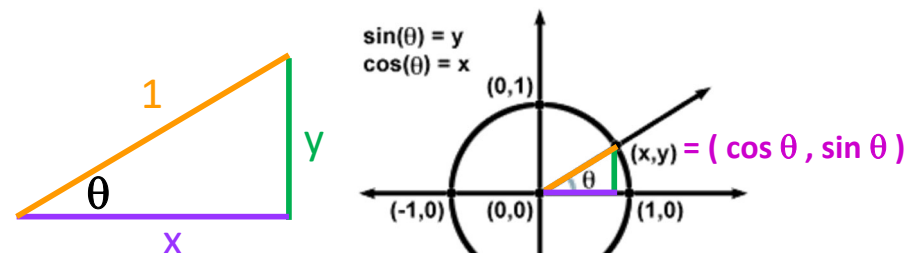
$$\cos A = b/c \quad \sec A = c/b$$

$$\tan A = a/b \quad \cot A = b/a$$



	30°	45°	60°
sin	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$	$\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$
cos	$\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$	$\frac{1}{2}$
tan	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$	1	$\sqrt{3}$

Note!! Trigonometry (Unit Circle)



$$\sin \theta = y/1 = y$$

$$\cos \theta = x/1 = x$$

$$\tan \theta = y/x$$

$$\operatorname{cosec} \theta = 1/y$$

$$\sec \theta = 1/x$$

$$\cot \theta = x/y$$

A Strategy for Finding Limits

THEOREM 1.7 FUNCTIONS THAT AGREE AT ALL BUT ONE POINT

Let c be a real number and let $f(x) = g(x)$ for all $x \neq c$ in an open interval containing c . If the limit of $g(x)$ as x approaches c exists, then the limit of $f(x)$ also exists and

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow c} g(x).$$

When the **limit of $f(x)$ cannot be found**,
use an **equivalent function $g(x)$** to find the limit of $f(x)$

EXAMPLE We cannot find $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^3 - 1}{x - 1}$ **Why ??? ?**

$$f(x) = \frac{(x-1)(x^2 + x + 1)}{(x-1)} = x^2 + x + 1 = g(x), \quad x \neq 1.$$

However, we can find the limit of $g(x)$.

EXAMPLE 6 Finding the Limit of a Function

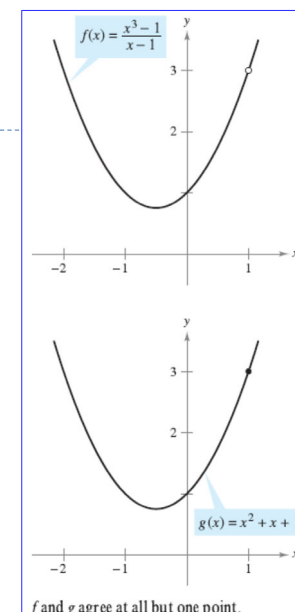
Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^3 - 1}{x - 1}$.

Solution you can rewrite f as

$$f(x) = \frac{(x-1)(x^2 + x + 1)}{(x-1)}$$

$$= x^2 + x + 1 = g(x), \quad x \neq 1.$$

So, for all x -values other than $x = 1$,
the functions f and g agree



f and g agree at all but one point.

EXAMPLE 6 Finding the Limit of a Function

Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^3 - 1}{x - 1}$.

Solution Because $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} g(x)$ exists, you can apply Theorem 1.7 to conclude that f and g have the same limit at $x = 1$.

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^3 - 1}{x - 1} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{(x - 1)(x^2 + x + 1)}{x - 1} && \text{Factor.} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{\cancel{(x - 1)}(x^2 + x + 1)}{\cancel{x - 1}} && \text{Divide out like factors.} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} (x^2 + x + 1) && \text{Apply Theorem 1.7.} \\ &= 1^2 + 1 + 1 && \text{Use direct substitution.} \\ &= 3 && \text{Simplify.} \end{aligned}$$

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A STRATEGY FOR FINDING LIMITS

1. Learn to recognize which limits can be evaluated by **direct substitution**. (These limits are listed in Theorems 1.1 through 1.6.)
2. If the limit of $f(x)$ as x approaches c *cannot* be evaluated by direct substitution, try to **find a function g that agrees with f for all x other than $x = c$** . [Choose g such that the limit of $g(x)$ *can* be evaluated by **direct substitution**.]
3. Apply Theorem 1.7 to conclude *analytically* that

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow c} g(x) = g(c).$$
4. Use a **graph or table** to reinforce your conclusion.

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Dividing Out and Rationalizing Techniques

dividing out common factors
rationalizing the numerator of a fractional expression

EXAMPLE 7 Dividing Out Technique

Dividing Out

Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow -3} \frac{x^2 + x - 6}{x + 3}$.

Solution Although you are taking the limit of a rational function, you **cannot** apply Theorem 1.3 because the limit of the **denominator is 0**.

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} \frac{x^2 + x - 6}{x + 3} &\begin{cases} \nearrow \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} (x^2 + x - 6) = 0 \\ \searrow \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} (x + 3) = 0 \end{cases} \\ &\quad \text{Direct substitution fails.} \end{aligned}$$

An expression such as $0/0$ is called an **indeterminate form**

you cannot (from the form alone) determine the limit. ⁵⁷

EXAMPLE 7 Dividing Out Technique

Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow -3} \frac{x^2 + x - 6}{x + 3}$.

Solution you must rewrite the fraction so that the new denominator does not have 0 as its limit.

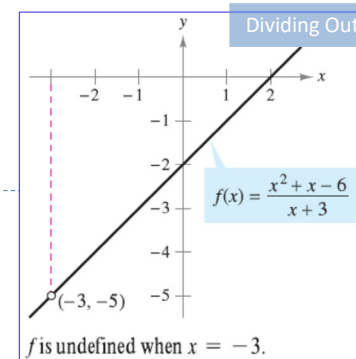
One way to do this is to *divide out like factors*

$$f(x) = \frac{x^2 + x - 6}{x + 3} = \frac{\cancel{(x + 3)}(x - 2)}{\cancel{x + 3}} \stackrel{\text{Dividing Out}}{=} x - 2 = g(x), \quad x \neq -3.$$

Using Theorem 1.7, it follows that

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} \frac{x^2 + x - 6}{x + 3} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} (x - 2) && \text{Apply Theorem 1.7.} \\ &= -5. && \text{Use direct substitution.} \end{aligned}$$

A second way is to *rationalize the numerator*, as shown in Example 8.



EXAMPLE 8 Rationalizing Technique

Rationalizing

Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}{x}$.

Solution By direct substitution, you obtain the indeterminate form $0/0$.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}{x} \quad \begin{array}{l} \nearrow \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} (\sqrt{x+1} - 1) = 0 \\ \searrow \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} x = 0 \end{array}$$

Direct substitution fails.

EXAMPLE 8 Rationalizing Technique

Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}{x}$.

Solution

you can rewrite the fraction by rationalizing the numerator

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}{x} &= \left(\frac{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}{x} \right) \left(\frac{\sqrt{x+1} + 1}{\sqrt{x+1} + 1} \right) \\ &= \frac{(x+1) - 1}{x(\sqrt{x+1} + 1)} \quad \text{Find the conjugate } (A+B)(A-B) = A^2 - B^2 \\ &= \frac{\cancel{x}}{\cancel{x}(\sqrt{x+1} + 1)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{x+1} + 1}, \quad x \neq 0 \end{aligned}$$

EXAMPLE 8 Rationalizing Technique

Find the limit: $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}{x}$.

Solution

Now, using Theorem 1.7, you can evaluate the limit as shown.

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{x+1} - 1}{x} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{\sqrt{x+1} + 1} \\ &= \frac{1}{1+1} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \end{aligned}$$

Continuity and One-Sided Limits

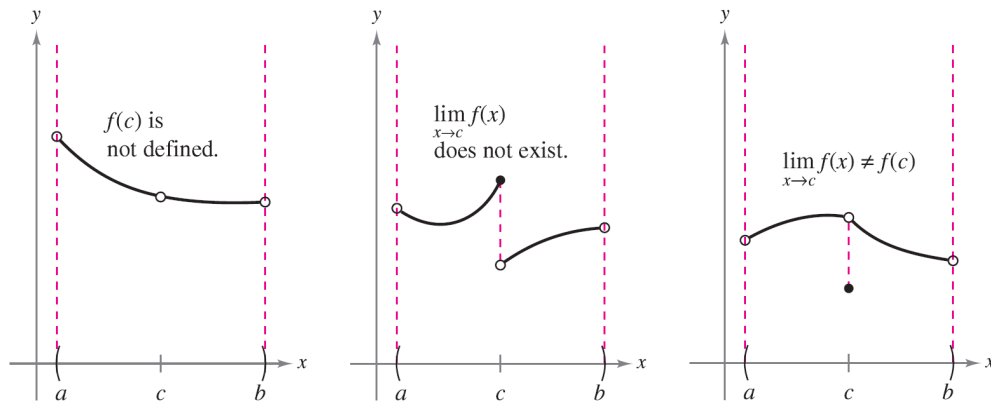
Objectives

- Determine continuity at a point and continuity on an open interval.
- Determine one-sided limits and continuity on a closed interval.

Continuity at a Point and on an Open Interval

Informally, to say that a function f is continuous at $x = c$ means that there is no interruption in the graph of f at c .

no holes, jumps, or gaps.



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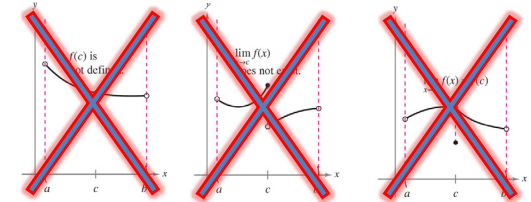
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Continuity at a Point and on an Open Interval

DEFINITION OF CONTINUITY

Continuity at a Point: A function f is **continuous at c** if the following three conditions are met.

1. $f(c)$ is defined.
2. $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x)$ exists.
3. $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = f(c)$



Continuity on an Open Interval: A function is **continuous on an open interval (a, b)** if it is continuous at each point in the interval. A function that is continuous on the entire real line $(-\infty, \infty)$ is **everywhere continuous**.

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Continuity

Determine if the following function is continuous at $x=2$.

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} x^2 + 2x, & \text{if } x \leq 2 \\ x^3 - 6x, & \text{if } x > 2 \end{cases}$$

Solution

-Function f is defined at $x=2$ since

$$f(2) = 2^2 + 2(2) = 8$$

-The left-hand limit $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} (x^2 + 2x) = 2^2 + 2(2) = 8$

- The right-hand limit $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} (x^3 - 6x) = 2^3 - 6(2) = -4$

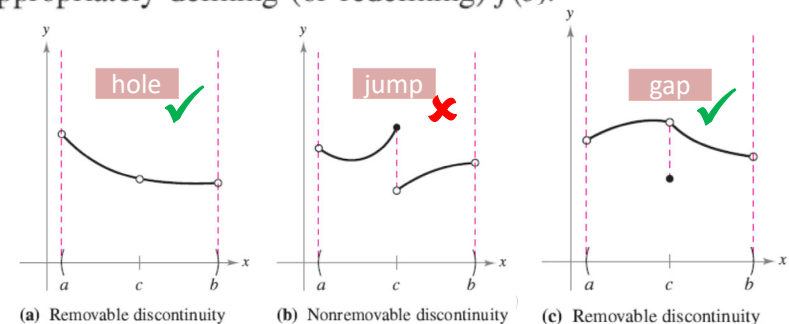
Since the left- and right-hand limits are not equal, $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} f(x)$ does not exist. Thus, function $f(x)$ is **NOT continuous at $x=2$** .

Continuity at a Point and on an Open Interval

f is not continuous at $c \rightarrow$ **discontinuity** at c .

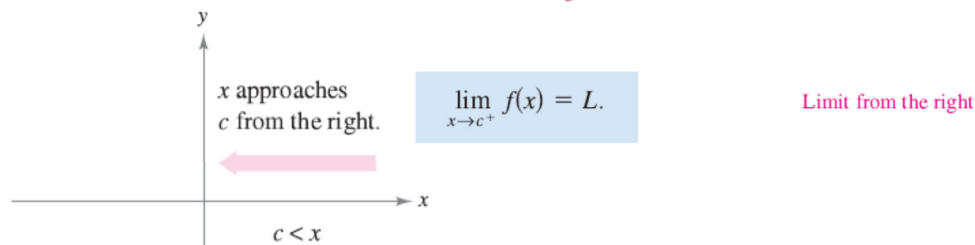
Discontinuities fall into two categories:
removable and **nonremovable**.

A discontinuity at c is called removable if f can be made continuous by appropriately defining (or redefining) $f(c)$.

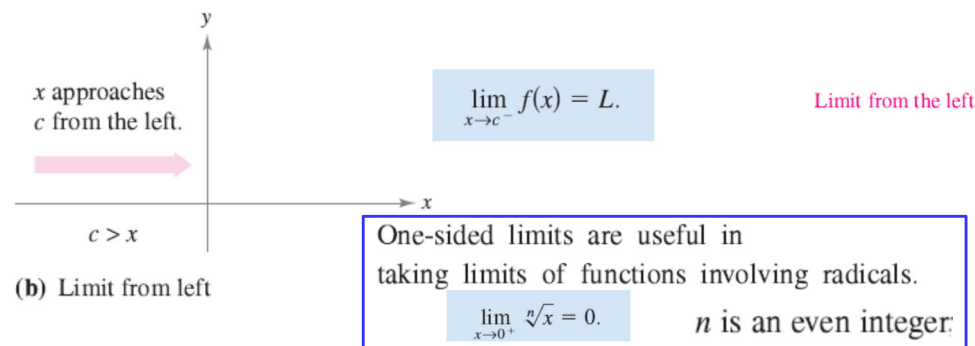


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One-Sided Limits and Continuity on a Closed Interval



(a) Limit from right



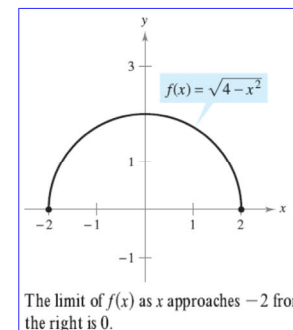
(b) Limit from left

EXAMPLE 2 A One-Sided Limit

Find the limit of $f(x) = \sqrt{4 - x^2}$ as x approaches -2 from the right.

Solution

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow -2^+} \sqrt{4 - x^2} = 0.$$



THEOREM 1.10 THE EXISTENCE OF A LIMIT

Let f be a function and let c and L be real numbers. The limit of $f(x)$ as x approaches c is L if and only if

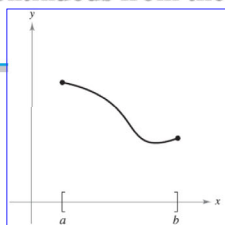
$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c^-} f(x) = L \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow c^+} f(x) = L.$$

DEFINITION OF CONTINUITY ON A CLOSED INTERVAL

A function f is **continuous on the closed interval $[a, b]$** if it is continuous on the open interval (a, b) and

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow a^+} f(x) = f(a) \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow b^-} f(x) = f(b).$$

The function f is **continuous from the right** at a and **continuous from the left** at b



Continuous function on a closed interval

EXAMPLE 4 Continuity on a Closed Interval

Discuss the continuity of $f(x) = \sqrt{1 - x^2}$.

Solution The domain of f is the closed interval $[-1, 1]$. At all points in the open interval $(-1, 1)$, the continuity of f follows from Theorems 1.4 and 1.5. Moreover, because

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow -1^+} \sqrt{1 - x^2} = 0 = f(-1) \quad \text{Continuous from the right}$$

and

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^-} \sqrt{1 - x^2} = 0 = f(1) \quad \text{Continuous from the left}$$

you can conclude that f is continuous on the closed interval $[-1, 1]$

